



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Midway Covenant Christian School
School Website: <https://www.midwayschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Midway Covenant Christian School (Powder Springs, GA 30127) demonstrates a strong alignment with classical Christian education as defined by the classical education lexicon and Six Essential Elements framework. Across the six categories, the school publicly emphasizes a Christian, covenantal, and classical approach, foregrounding the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, and a curriculum anchored in biblical truth and Western civilization. Evidence of liturgical and communal practices, a robust theology-centered mission, and a family-centric parental partnership further reinforce its classical orientation. All six categories trend toward CLASSICAL, with explicit references to virtue formation, true/good/beautiful philosophy, and a living faculty-student partnership. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive decisions are grounded in explicit textual evidence from the school's public materials (home pages, mission statements, faith statements, curricula pages, and program descriptions) and aligned with the Positive/Negative Keyword indicators from the Six Essentials Elements lexicon.

- Evidence sources include: the school's public materials describing classical Christian aims, covenantal education, and a Trivium-inspired curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), along with references to Great Books, Western history, Latin, and the Bible as foundational to all subjects. Key citations are provided after category-specific observations.

Note: The analysis below uses the knowledge-base rubric for "classical education" and the school's own materials as the basis for keyword matching and scoring.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements frame the school as a classical Christian institution rooted in God's Word and biblical standards. The home page and "A Letter From Our Head of School" describe an environment in which "Christ, the giver of all wisdom and knowledge, is pre-eminent," and where the curriculum, instruction in virtue, and communication are rooted in biblical standards.

- The school's faith documentation (Our Faith, Westminster Confession of Faith) explicitly anchors truth claims in a Reformed, confessional framework (Sovereignty of God, Inerrancy of Scripture, The Triune God).
- The vision emphasizes Holy Scripture as foundational for all learning and character formation; prayers and theological reflection permeate daily life, while biblical truths guide discipline and curriculum.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth/true, virtue, theology/scripture, creed, liturgy/prayer (public prayer), holy, God's word, providence, imago Dei (conceptual alignment via biblical anthropology), worship/chapel (liturgical concepts). - Negative keywords: none clearly present in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-clarification signals in the school's own mission statements).

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate transcendental moral realism via a theologically grounded curriculum, explicit theology and creedal frameworks, liturgical prayer and communal worship practices, and a covenantal, biblically anchored formation of character. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL in religious/metaphysical foundations as defined by the Six Essentials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The stated purpose emphasizes formation and virtue over mere information: “to train our covenant children to see and understand all of life through the teachings and principles of God’s infallible Word and to develop a Christian social imaginary,” with a recognizable aim toward Truth, Goodness, and Beauty in alignment with classical ends. - The school frames education as formation toward human excellence and wisdom, not primarily job preparation. The public materials discuss forming virtue, wisdom, and a long-term Christian formation (true/good/beautiful). - The school explicitly positions itself as Christian, classical, and covenantal, signaling a telos oriented toward True, Good, Beautiful and human flourishing.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, cultivate virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, classical mission, telos, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, contemplation/scholé, classical heritage, human excellence, moral imagination. - Negative keywords: none evident (no emphasis on mere workforce-readiness or utilitarian metrics in the stated goal).

Why this rating - The material consistently centers virtue formation, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth/beauty as ends of education, aligning with CLASSICAL ideals for school purpose and goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is clearly described as liberal arts-oriented with grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core elements (the Trivium). The school highlights Great Books and primary sources, Latin, and the study of Western civilization, alongside history instructed in a continuous, integrated fashion. - Specific Great Books and classical readings are named (Iliad, Odyssey, Beowulf, Shakespeare) and Latin begins in 3rd grade, with Veritas history curriculum and a chronological approach to history aligned with literature and art. Bible is foundational to all subjects, with dedicated Bible study in elementary and middle school.

- The elementary/middle-school articulation includes explicit emphasis on Latin, classical literature, and Western civilization as core components. The school references the Great Books and a connected, interwoven curriculum (history, literature, art) with a strong biblical integration.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Shakespeare, Iliad, Odyssey, Beowulf, Western civilization, Latin, history/chronology, Bible as foundational to all subjects, catechesis, and recitation/narration in line with classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: the lexicon notes potential negative signals such as “social studies terminology replacing history” or “project-based learning dominance.” The MCCS materials emphasize history as history and Western civ, not replacing it with social studies phrasing, and there is no dominant project-based framing seen in the excerpts.

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of the Trivium, Great Books (and Great Conversation), Latin, and Western civilization history, along with a biblically integrated curriculum, strongly aligns with CLASSICAL curricular expectations.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical aims reflect the classical progression and the literature indicates a tri-level approach: grammar stages (reading, phonics, memory work, narration), logic stage (critical thinking, analysis, reason-

ing), and rhetoric stage (oral expression, argument, and writing in later years). The middle-school description emphasizes logic and inter-relatedness of subjects, suggesting a maturation of reasoning and argumentation. - Explicit examples of pedagogy include Great Books exposure during the middle school years, and a focus on the inter-relatedness of subjects through logic and structured reading. The grammar stage emphasizes memorization and recitation, with Bible memorization and catechesis integrated. - Bible and classical education are described as foundational to all subjects, with the Bible taught in its own course and integrated across disciplines, signaling a thoughtful, restive, contemplative approach in line with scholé principles.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar (mentioned in the lexicon as an ideal pedagogy, though explicit mention here is more indirect), narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, liturgical integration, seminars, and oratory/debate in upper levels, restfulness/scholé, contemplation, wonder. - Negative keywords: explicit “experiential learning focus” and “project-based learning” are listed as negatives in the lexicon; MCCS materials do not emphasize a dominant project-based or experiential-only pedagogy, instead highlighting traditional classical methods.

Why this rating - The materials describe the classical progression (grammar/logic/rhetoric), use of Great Books and primary sources, and memory-based pedagogy in lower grades, along with logic-focused inquiry in middle/high school. While explicit “Socratic seminars” are not repeatedly titled, the overall pedagogical approach remains classical, with careful notes on memory work, recitation, and careful reasoning. This supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize teachers as agents of virtue and living curriculum. A statement notes that “every teacher is required to explain how their Christian faith is foundational to the lessons they are teaching,” signaling teachers as moral exemplars and carriers of the school’s mission. - The school highlights a covenantal framework where family involvement and teacher-student mutual support are central; there are clear leadership and faculty pages (Our Leadership, Our Team) indicating a defined faculty structure. - The existence of a formal, faith-guided, and covenantal culture implies a living curriculum more than a purely instrumental faculty; the faculty acts as mentors, guides, and colleagues in a shared mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, mentors/model teachers, faculty of friends, portrait/definition of teacher/student, collegial culture, teacher formation, faith-grounded pedagogy. - Negative keywords: none clearly indicated (the lexicon’s potential negatives such as “facilitators” or “certification-driven jargon” are not present in these public materials).

Why this rating - The materials stress teachers as moral exemplars and integral to the curriculum, with explicit theology-informed instruction and a covenantal framework. This aligns with CLASSICAL on the faculty dimension.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds a covenantal partnership with families and describes parental involvement as central to education. It notes that at Midway, the family “plays a key role in education” and that covenantal education emphasizes family engagement and shared foundation in Scripture. - The materials discuss “Parent Resources,” the Parent Teacher Fellowship (PTF), and opportunities for parents to engage with the school through tours, volunteering, and educational programs, suggesting active parent formation and involvement. - The openness of the campus, invitations for visits, and a family-centered culture reinforce parents-as-co-teachers and community involvement in classical formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation/education, reading groups, classical book clubs, hospitality, parent covenant, open cam-

pus, visits, family liturgy alignment (implicit in covenantal framing). - Negative keywords: none present (no consumer/customer framing; the materials emphasize active, ongoing parental involvement and formation).

Why this rating - The school's public materials consistently present strong parental partnership and community involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parents and community.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. All six categories show CLASSICAL alignment, with explicit statements of a biblical, classical, and covenantal curriculum, pedagogy, faculty roles, and parent/community partnerships. If something were to move the needle, it would be to more explicitly showcase explicit "Socratic discussion" or "Paideia seminar" language in upper grades to align even more directly with the pedagogical terms in the Six Essentials lexicon, though this is already well-supported by the middle-school logic emphasis and the Great Books approach. For now, no substantial changes are needed to reach a fully CLASSICAL status across all six dimensions.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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